Conversion and Extraction

Here we're going to focus on the string functions that PHP offers for making new data from existing string data. These functions take two general forms: functions for creating (or populating existing) arrays containing sub-strings of the original and functions for extracting single sub-strings.

Creating Arrays or Variables

Table 8-12. *String parsing and conversion functions*

`explode()`	Create array of sub-strings from a string using a separator sequence
`str_split()`, `mb_str_split()`	Create an array of sub-strings with a fixed size
`str_getcsv()`	Parse delimited string data, create an array
`sscanf()`	Parse a string using a sprintf format, create variables
`parse_str()`, `mb_parse_str()`	Parse a string in HTTP query format, populates an array

Let's start with one of the most wonderfully named functions in the history of programming…

explode()

A very common use-case is the creation of an array containing the words (or some other text sub-unit) in a string, where each word is separated by a given character (usually a space or a newline).

```
$quote = 'We demand rigidly defined areas of doubt and uncertainty!';

print_r(explode(' ', $quote));

Output:
Array
(
    [0] => We
    [1] => demand
```